

Kun Zhang

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Education

University of Navarra Pamplona, Spain
Master in Economics and Finance (MEF) Expected 2026
Relevant: Econometrics, Mathematical Economics, Real Analysis, Statistics & Probability, Advanced Finance, Corporate Finance

Hanyang University Seoul, Korea
Exchange, College of Economics and Finance Fall 2023

Yantai Institute of Technology Shandong, China
B.A., cum laude 2024

Research

Working Paper

“Institutional Common Ownership and Executive Mobility”

Supervisor: Prof. José Azar (IESE & UNAV)

Exploiting the BlackRock-BGI merger (2009) as a quasi-natural experiment, I examine how institutional common ownership shapes C-suite executive mobility. Using difference-in-differences and event study designs on a 27.8-million-row panel linking 13F institutional holdings (58.9M observations), ExecuComp executive data (31,959 executive-years), and Orbis director moves (24,716 transitions), I find that common ownership *increases* mobility by facilitating within-network labor market channels—rejecting the shadow non-compete hypothesis. Robust to 17 pair-level checks, placebo tests, and high-dimensional fixed effects.

Presented at: IESE Madrid Work & Organizations Workshop (MWOW 2026), IESE AI Conference (2026)

Technical Highlight

Panel construction: 27.8M rows | DiD + Event Study (2005–2020) | FWL high-dimensional FE | Placebo & RESET tests | Python (pandas, statsmodels) + Stata + LaTeX

Selected Conferences

IESE MWOW 2026 Madrid, May 21–22, 2026
Madrid Work & Organizations Workshop. Keynotes: Erin L. Kelly (MIT Sloan), Lauren A. Rivera (Kellogg).
Paper presented: “Institutional Common Ownership and Executive Mobility”

IESE AI Conference 2026
Delegate

Roads to Development 2026
Delegate

Skills & Languages

Technical: Python (pandas, statsmodels, NumPy), Stata, SQL, LaTeX, Git, JavaScript

Languages: English (C1), Chinese (Native), Spanish (A2)

Seeking: Pre-doctoral Research Assistant positions (2026–2027), with long-term goal of Ph.D. in Financial Economics